

The Achievement Gap Initiative At Harvard University

Toward Excellence with Equity

American Association of State Colleges and Universities
Annual Meeting in New Orleans, October 29, 2012

Addressing the American Challenge:
A 21st Century Social Movement for Birth-to-Career Excellence with Equity

Ronald F. Ferguson
Harvard University

"It's a Sputnik moment. Communities are going to rise or fall depending upon whether they have a workforce."

"We need to stop having meetings and have a movement."

Bill Shore, GlaxoSmithKline

Director of U.S. Community Partnerships

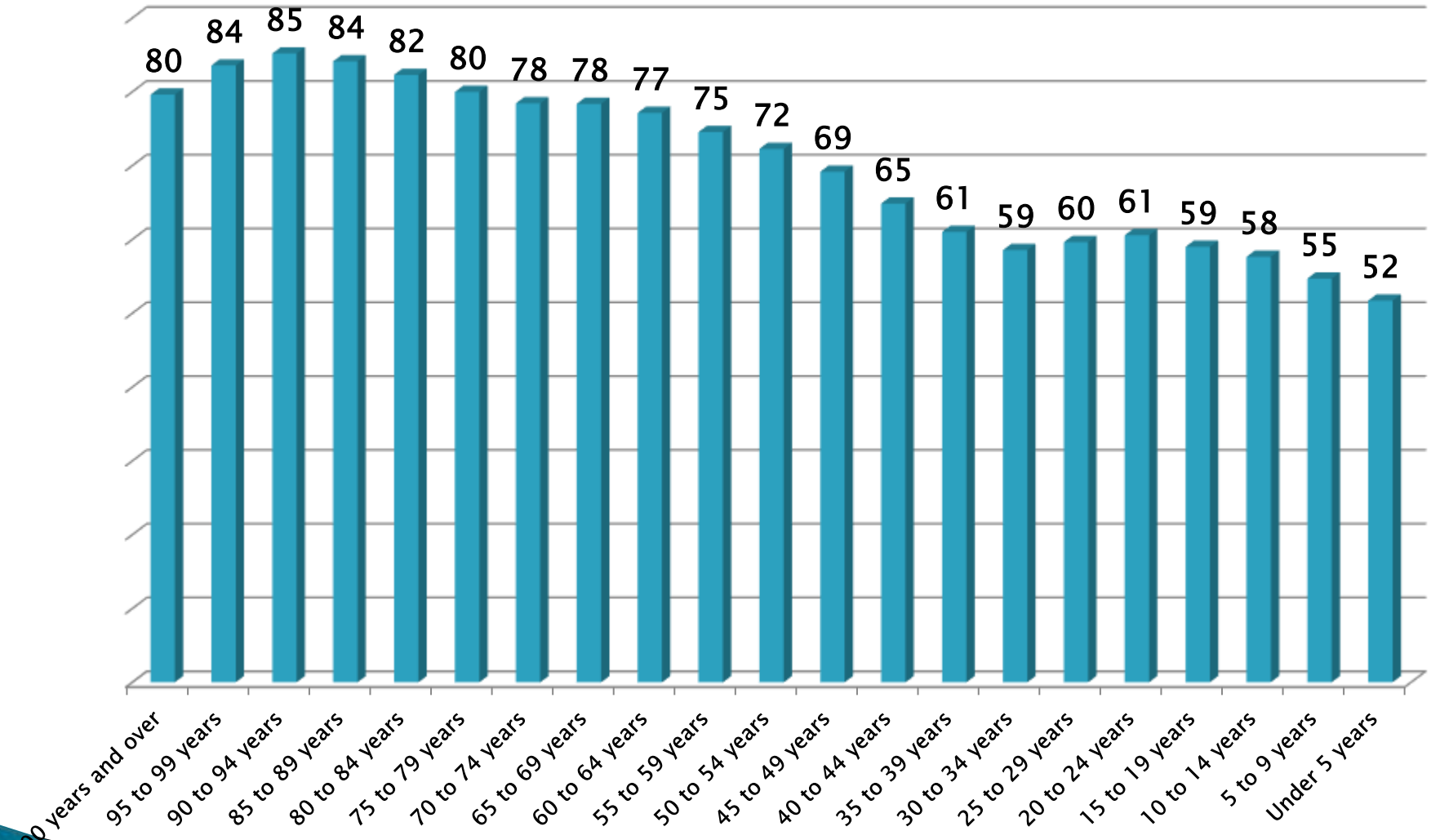
North Carolina Chamber of Commerce Education Summit, July 2011

Excellence with Equity is Possible!

- Few if any group differences among one-year olds—it appears groups start from the same place as infants
- Racial IQ gaps are smaller than in the past.
- NAEP trends for 17-year olds showed dramatic gap narrowing between 1970 and 1990, showing that rapid progress is possible.
- NAEP trends for 9-year olds show movement toward ***group-proportional equality*** (i.e., all rising but lowest groups rising faster)
- Exemplary schools and colleges are showing the way.

Why Such Urgency
to achieve *Excellence with Equity*?

Percentage Non-Hispanic White in the United States Age Distribution in 2009.

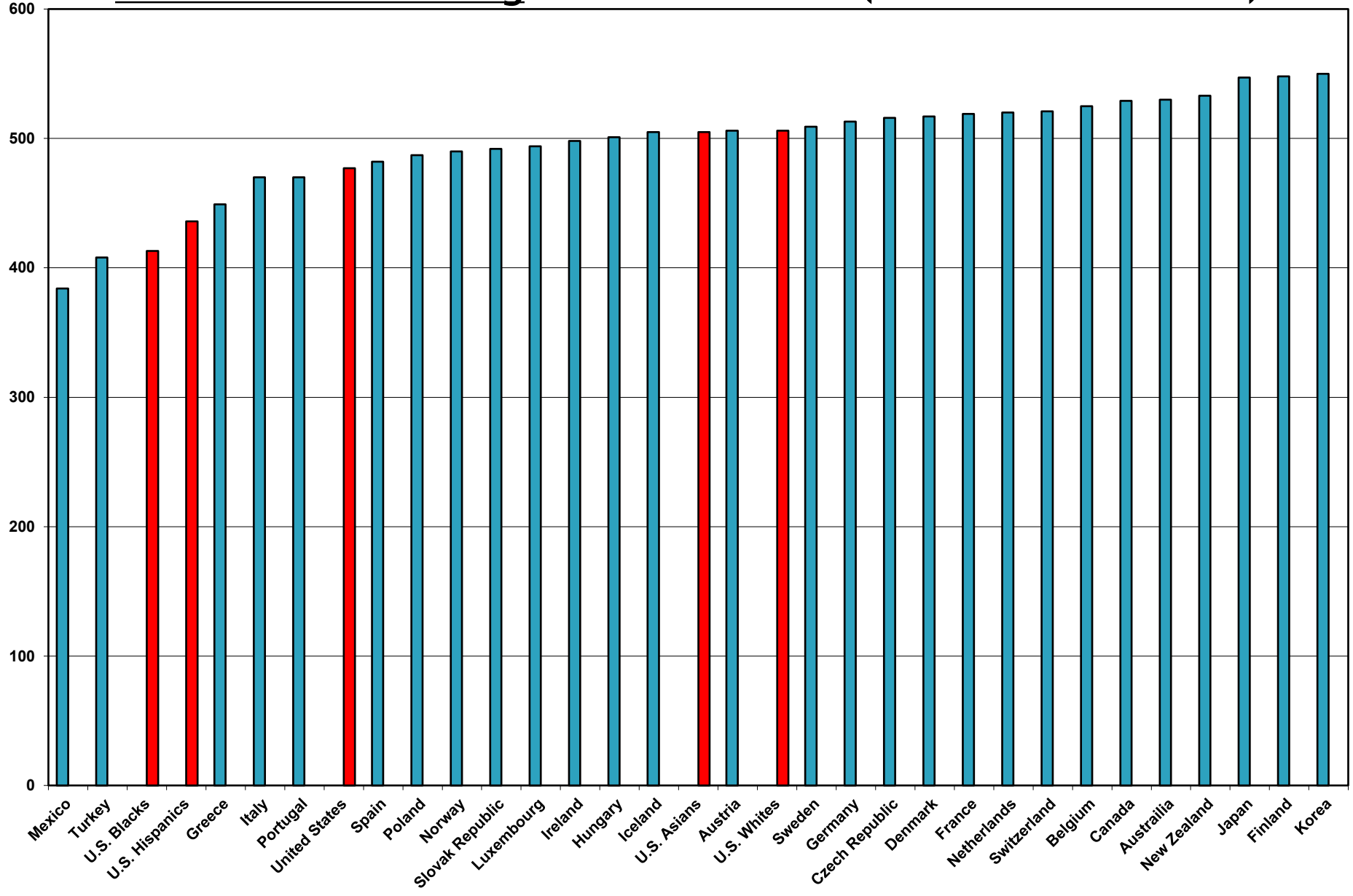


Source: U.S. Bureau of the Census
http://www.census.gov/popest/estimates.php

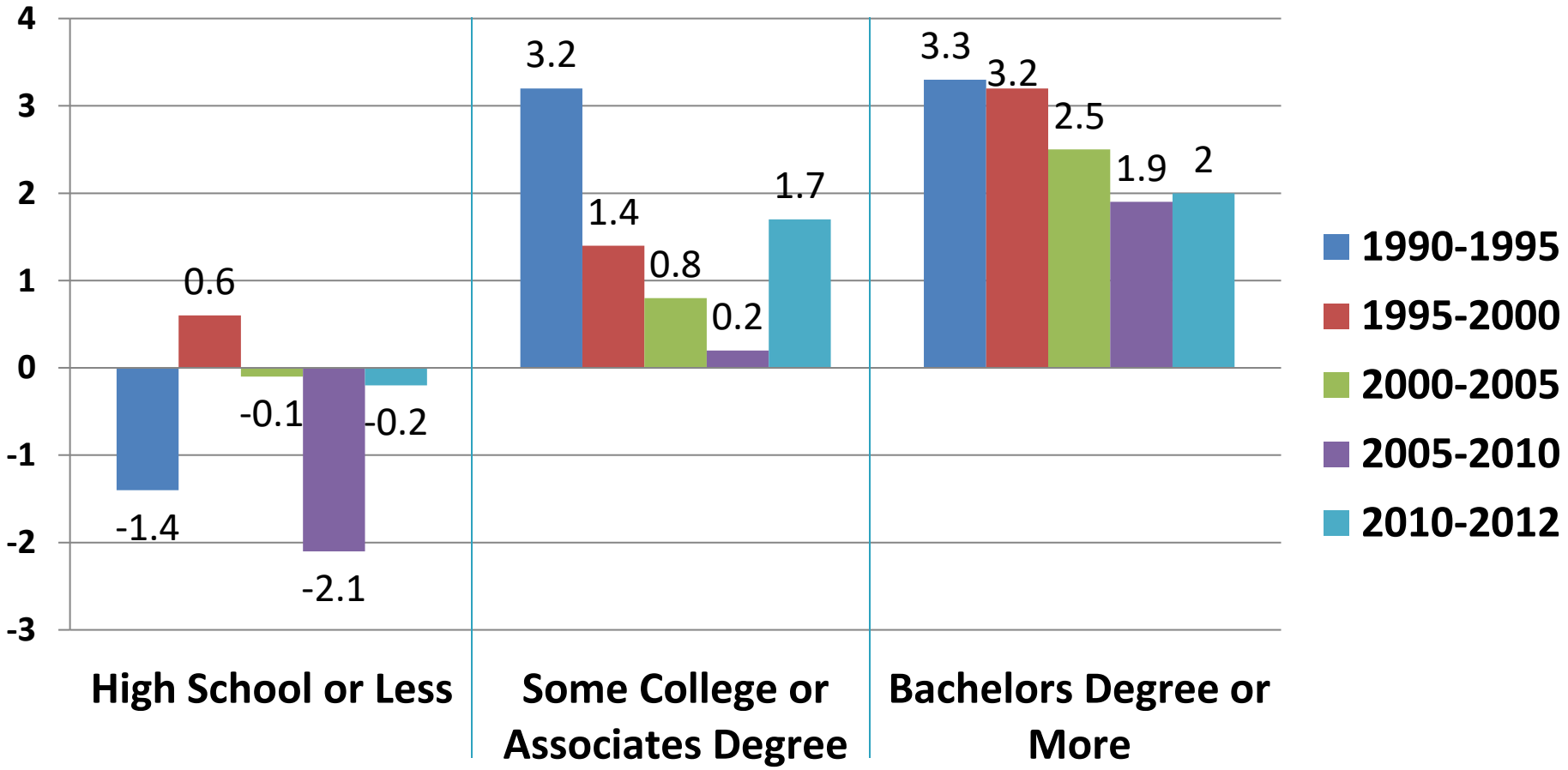
Failing to prepare millions for the 21st century economy:

- STAGNANT HIGH SCHOOL COMPLETION RATES: The US has failed to substantially increase high school graduation rates (versus GED's) over the past half century. And, many other nations have been moving past us.
- LAGGING SKILLS: Standardized test scores among African American and Latino 17-year olds, on average, equal the scores of white and Asian Americans who are between three and four years younger. At the same time, *even white teens* in the U.S. score lower in math problem solving than teens in a dozen other nations.

Program for International Student Assessment, 15-Year Olds, 2003, Math Problem Solving in OECD Nations (Red = U.S. Students)

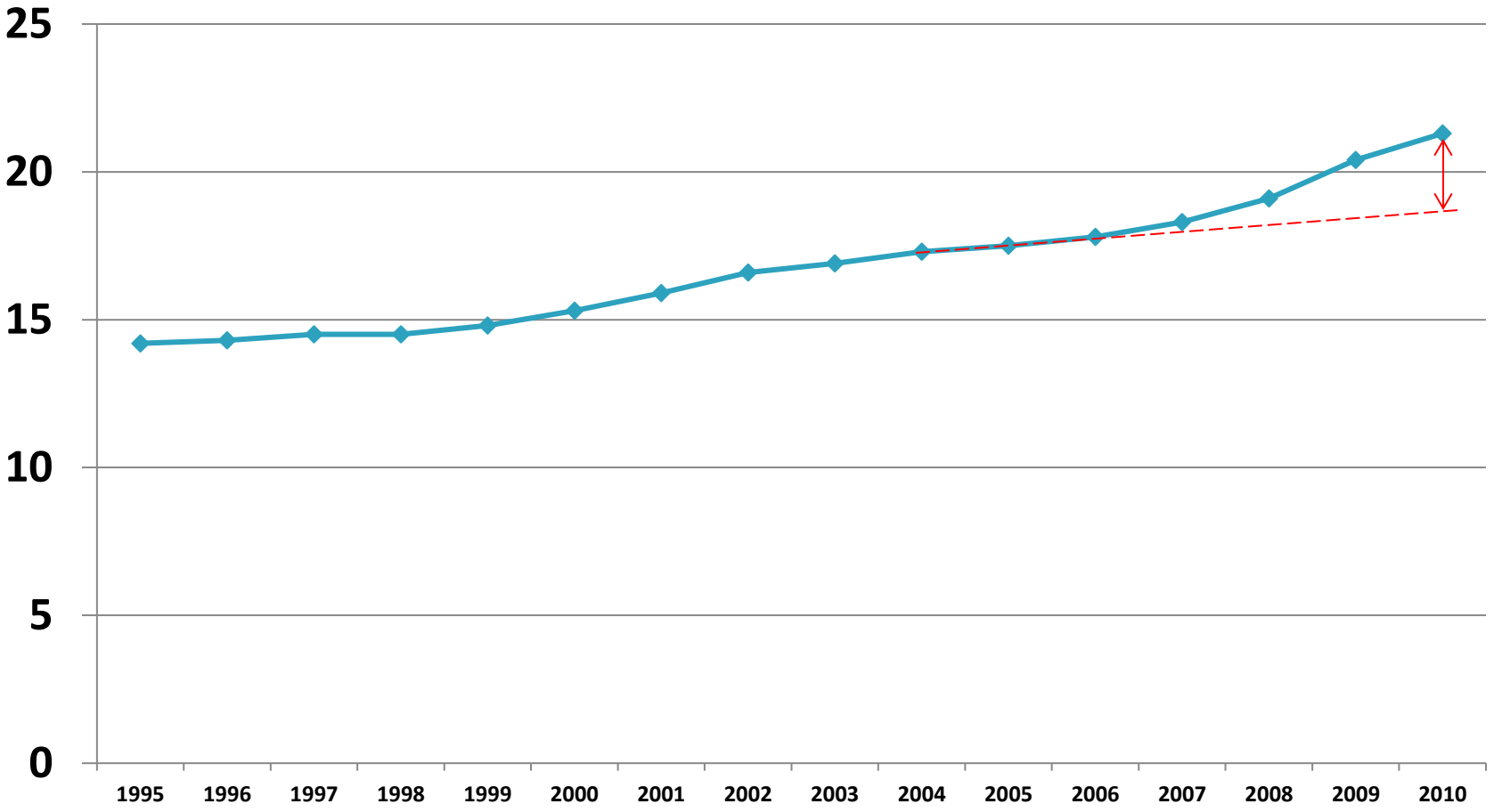


Employment of workers with a Bachelor's degree or better grew at a 2 percent to 3 percent rate over the past two decades.



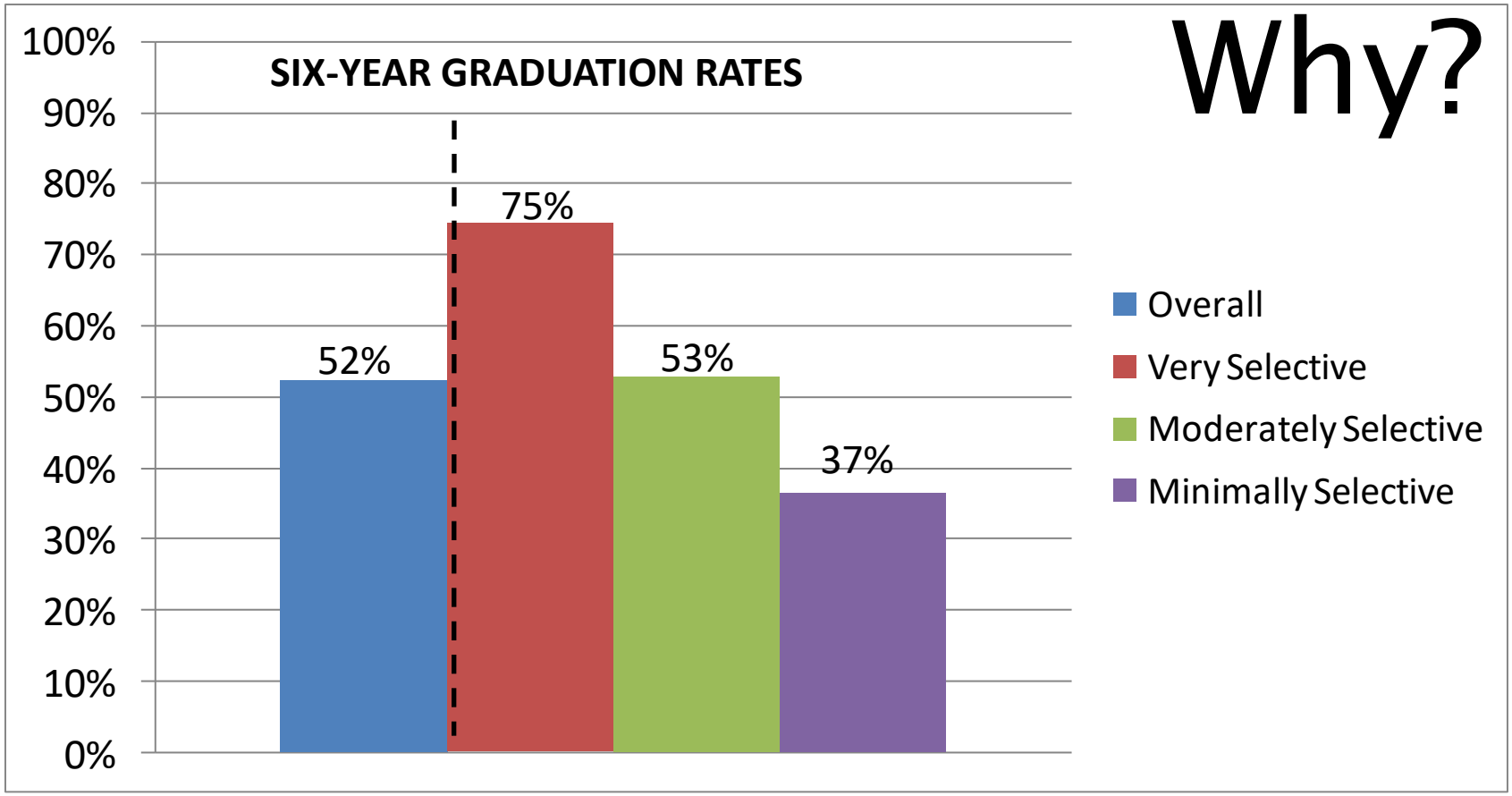
Source: Anthony Carnevale, Tamara Jaysundera and Ban Cheah, 2012. "The College Advantage: Weathering the Economic Storm." Georgetown University Center on Education and the Workforce.

Good News: Fall 2010 enrollment (millions) in postsecondary degree-granting institutions exceeded projected enrollment by 12 percent



Source: Anthony Carnevale, Tamara Jaysundera and Ban Cheah, 2012. "The College Advantage: Weathering the Economic Storm." Georgetown University Center on Education and the Workforce.

Bad News: Only about 50% of students who start complete a four-year degree in six years and rates vary dramatically by the selectivity of institution

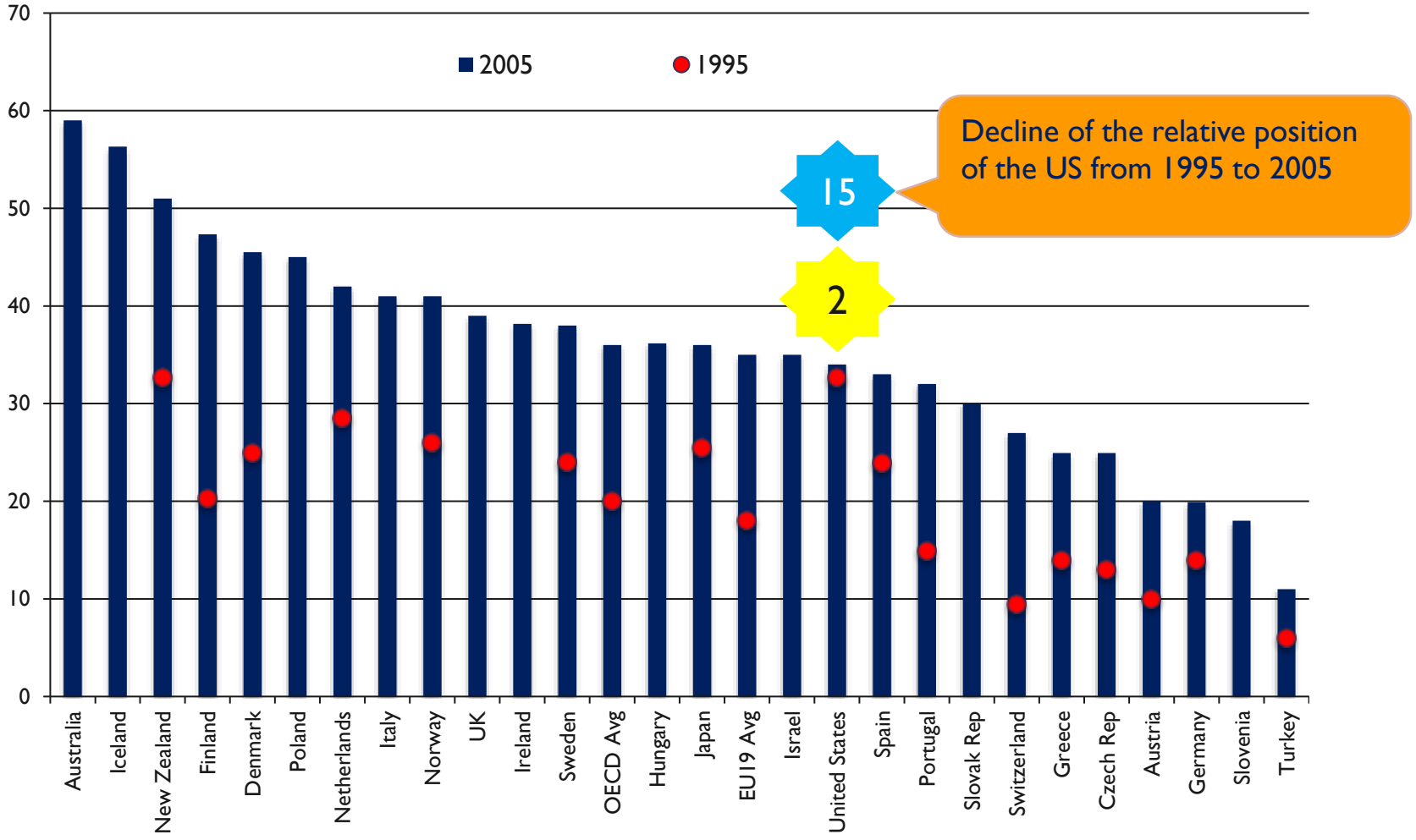


Note: Graduation rates are based on freshmen who enroll in the fall of a specified year, who have never attended college before, who attend full-time when they begin and who intend to complete a degree. On average 71% of admitted freshmen fell into this category. Selectivity scale is based on Carnegie Classifications, which is based on number of applicants, number of students admitted, ACT and SAT scores, whether test scores were required, and whether the school was open admissions

Source: NCES - IPEDS, "Placing Graduation Rates in Context" (2006), Table 6

Falling behind other nations' college graduation rates

Over a single decade, the U.S. fell from 2nd to 15th in college completion rates.



Source: Schleicher (2007) based on OECD data. Percentage of tertiary type A graduates to the population at the typical age of graduation.

We need high quality nurturance
from birth-to-career.

Whose responsibility is it
to see the big picture
and help lead *a movement* to achieve it?

How about college and university presidents
and chancellors?

Key Elements of a Regional System

Powerful Leadership that Proclaims, Supports and Sustains a Strong Mandate

Chairs and Top Executive Officers from:

Major Businesses, Leading Civic Organizations, Colleges and Universities,

State and Local Government Officials, Philanthropies

Private or Quasi-Public Intermediary Organization(s) as Major "Engines"

Tasks: map the system to identify gaps, document, track and monitor performance for support and accountability, elicit youth perspectives, maintain a youth registry, . . .

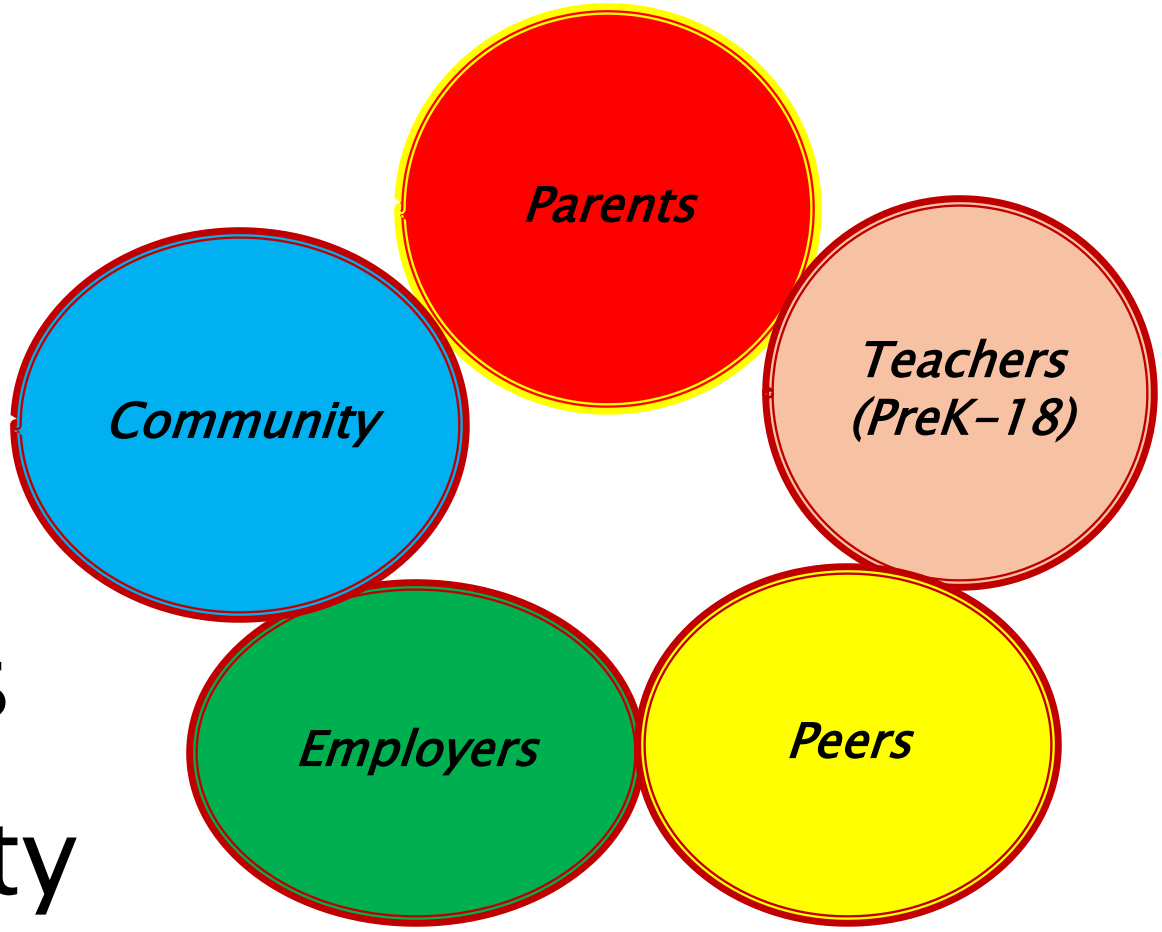
Front Line Organizations that work with Young People

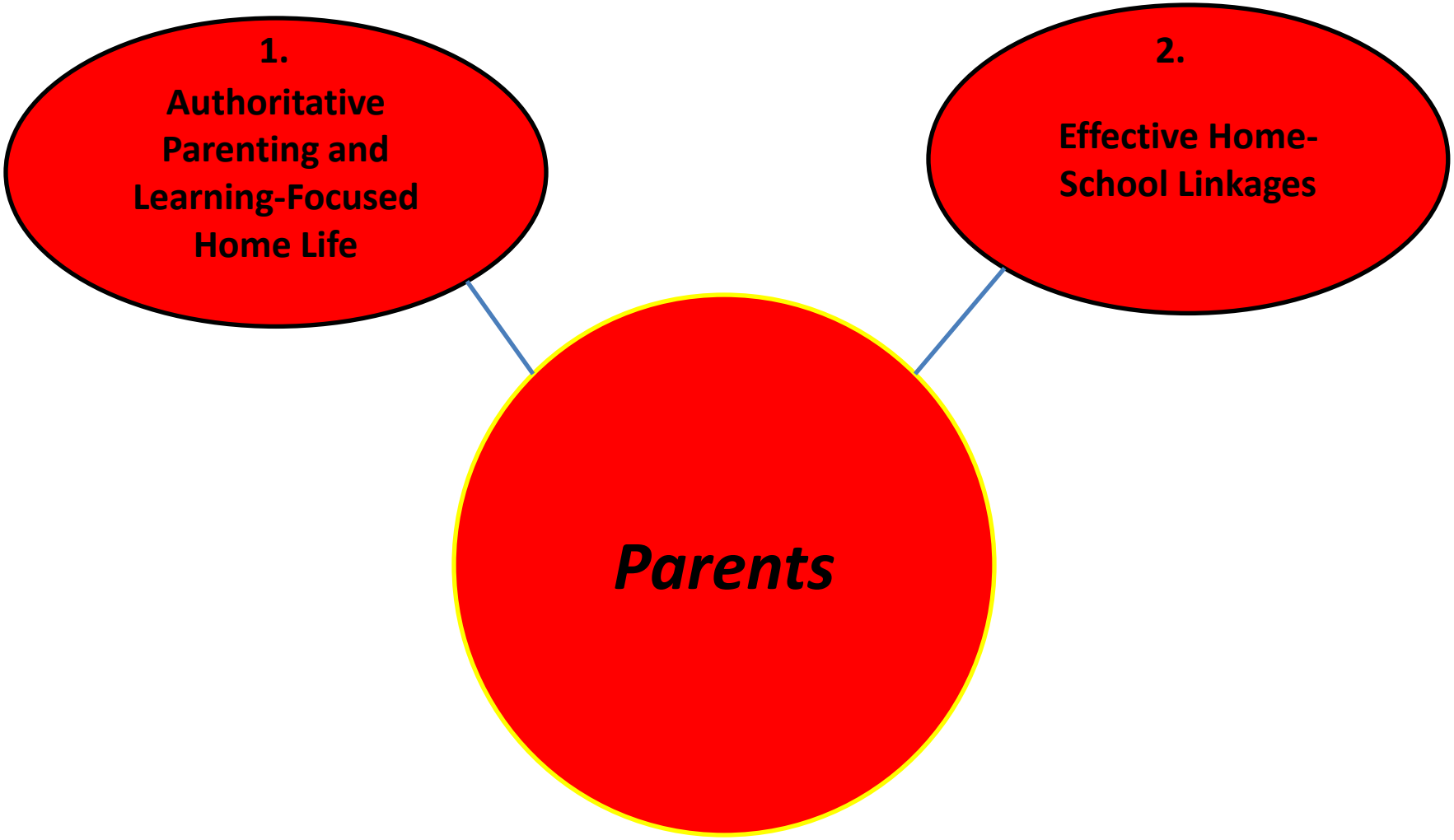
- Elementary and middle schools → High Schools
- Community & Four-Year Colleges
- Independent Training Programs
- Training Programs in Firms

Post-Secondary Outcomes for Young Adults

KEY RESEARCH-BASED ROLES for:

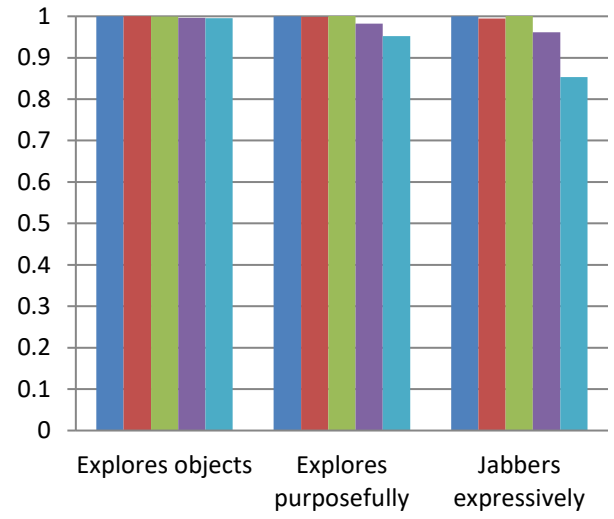
- Parents
- Teachers
- Peers
- Employers
- Community



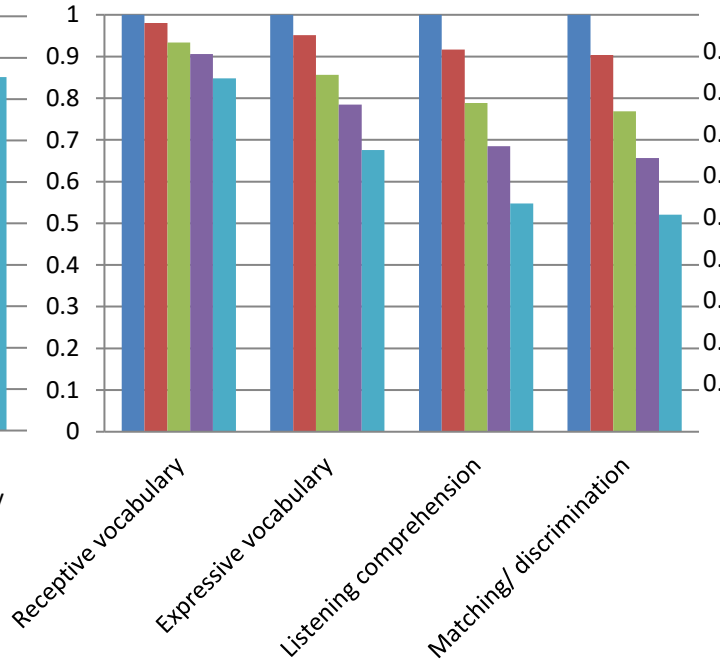

1.
Authoritative Parenting and Learning-Focused Home Life
2.
Effective Home-School Linkages
Parents

Skills among young children, by age and parents education level.

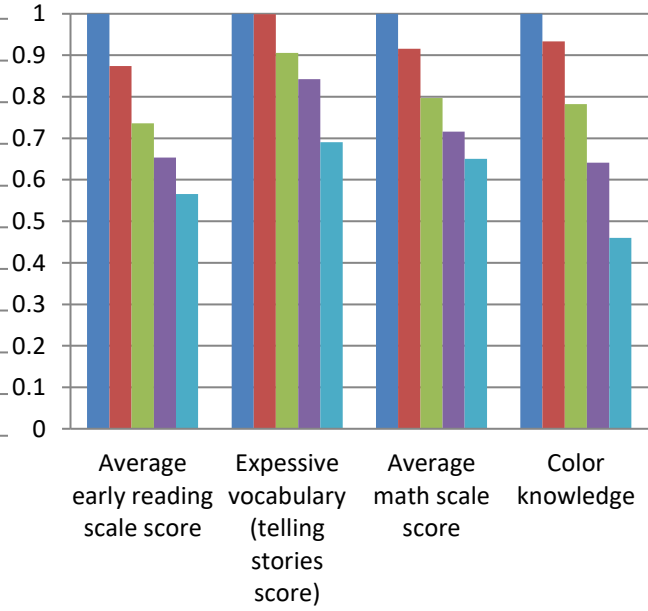
Average scores around age 1
(relative to those with grad-school parents)



Average scores around age 2
(relative to those with grad-school parents)



Average scores around age 4
(relative to those with grad-school parents)



- **Any graduate education**
- **Bachelor's degree**
- **Some college/vocational**
- **High school completion**
- **Less than high school**

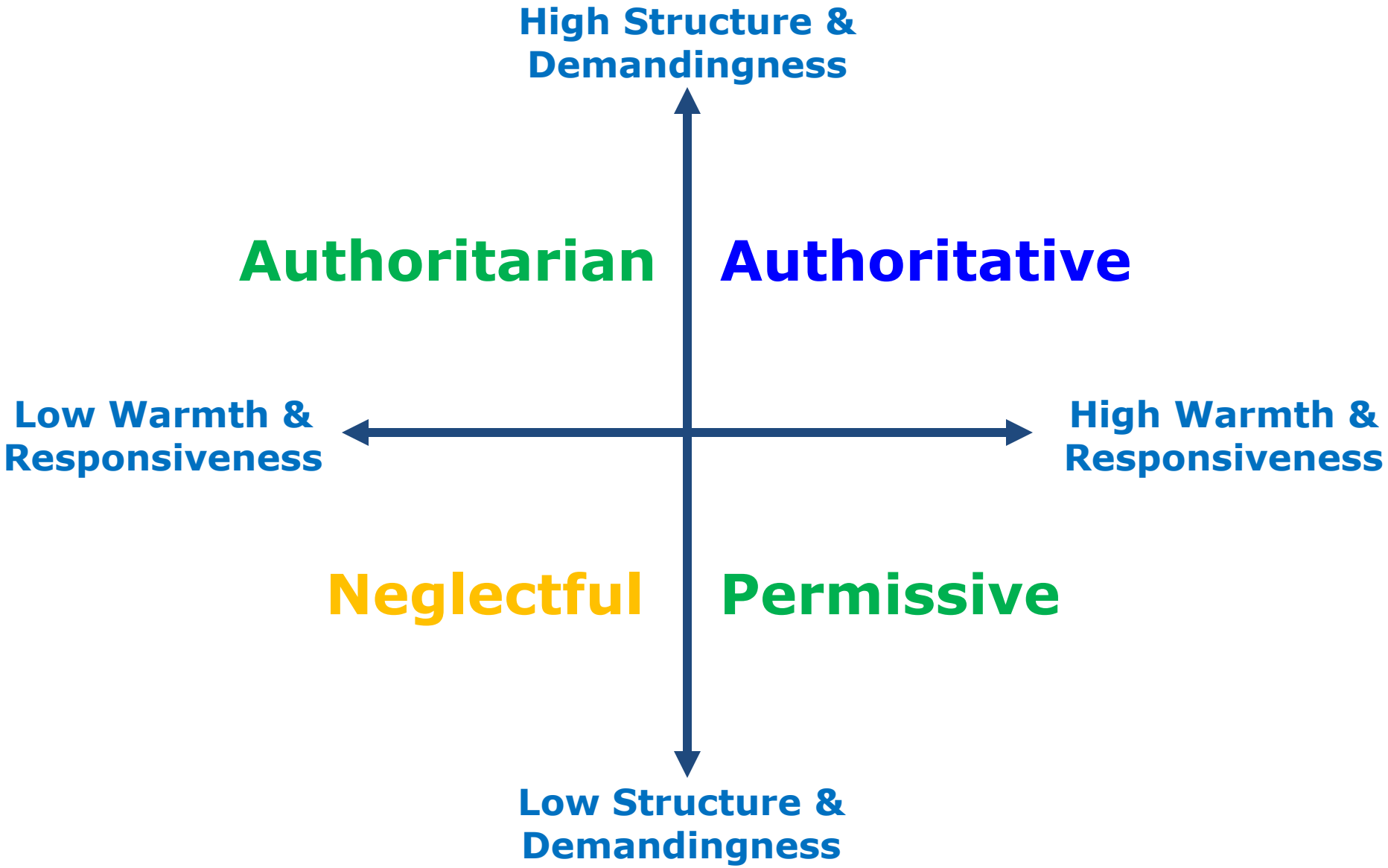
Source: Calculations using the federal Early Childhood Longitudinal Study, Birth Cohort.

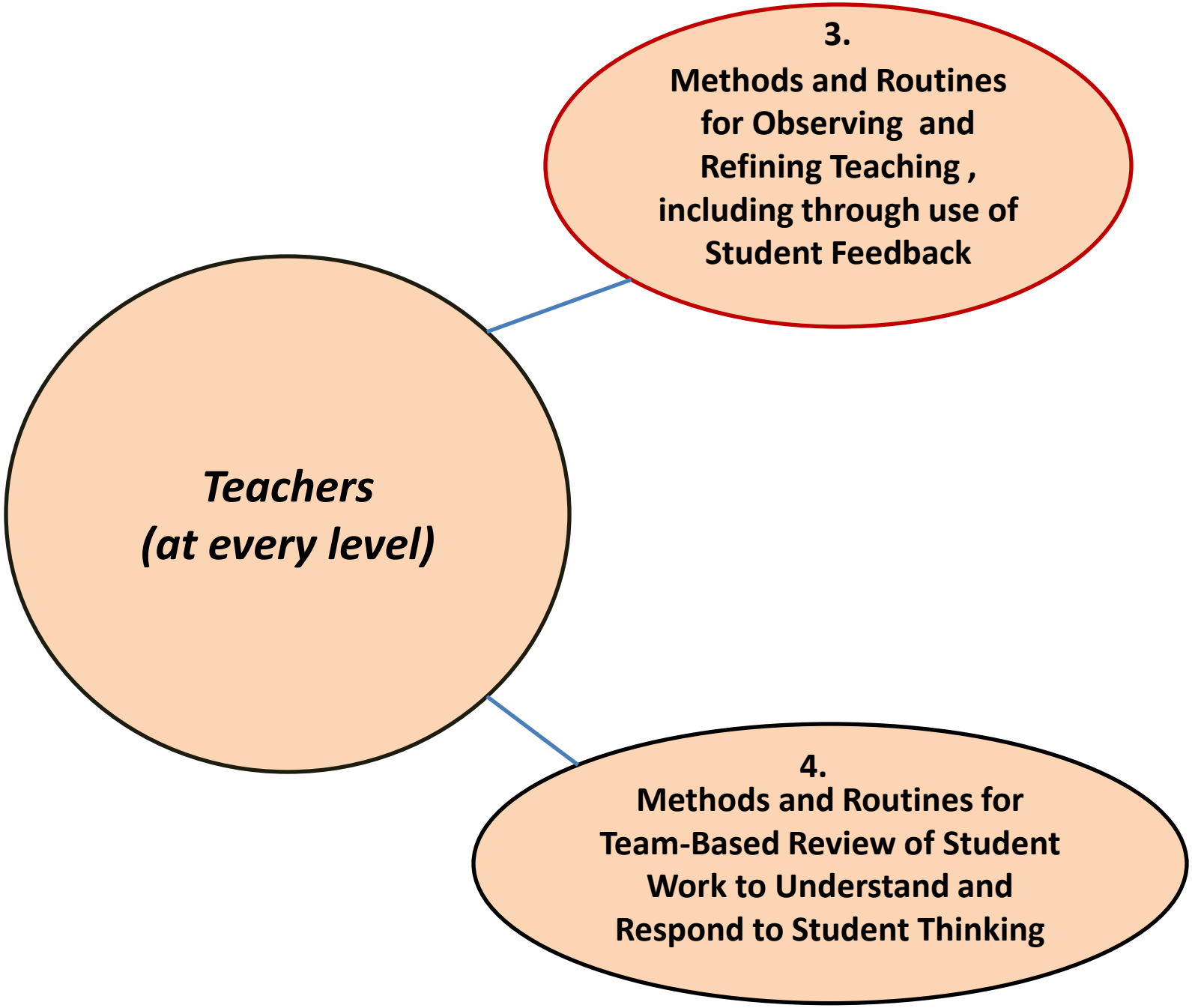
Research-Based Messages for Early Parenting:

- Maximize love, minimize stress beginning at birth
- Talk, sing and use gestures to communicate with infants to accelerate comprehension and language development
- Use number games and rhythm with toddlers to build foundations for numeracy
- Enable and encourage spatial awareness by providing opportunities to crawl in cluttered spaces and handle 3-dimensional objects
- Discuss what you read and see, don't just read. Mix higher- and lower-order discussion: remember, explain and anticipate.

We need to saturate communities—workplaces, schools, media—with this type of advice.

Parenting Styles with School-Aged Kids




3.
Methods and Routines for Observing and Refining Teaching , including through use of Student Feedback
Teachers (at every level)
4.
Methods and Routines for Team-Based Review of Student Work to Understand and Respond to Student Thinking

What is quality teaching and why does it matter?

The Tripod 7Cs and MET

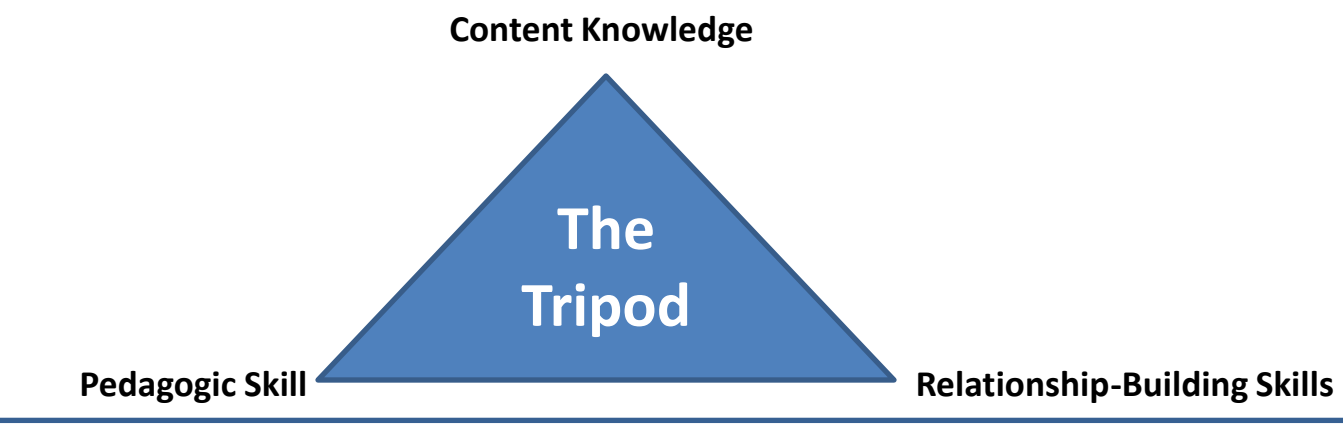
STUDENT ACHIEVEMENT OUTCOMES

The Tripod 7C's

(What Teachers Do)

Student Engagement

Teacher Professional Learning (PLCs)



The Seven C's

What Teachers Do (What Students Experience)

1. ***Caring*** about students (Encouragement and Emotional Support)
2. ***Captivating*** students (Learning seems Interesting and Relevant
3. ***Conferring*** with students (Students Sense their Ideas are Respected)
4. ***Clarifying*** lessons (Success Seems Feasible)
5. ***Consolidatin***g knowledge (Ideas get Connected and Integrated)

SUPPORT

6. ***Challenging*** students (Press for Effort, Perseverance and Rigor)
7. ***Controlling*** behavior (Culture of Cooperation and Peer Support)

PRESS

Which is the strongest predictor of value added test score gains?

“Color Schemes” for Two Secondary Schools

School One: Ranked 7th out of 49 that had at least 100 respondents (N=356 students)								
	Control	Challenge	Care	Confer	Captivate	Consolidate	Clarify	RowMean
A	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1.0
B	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1.0
C	1	1	1	2	1	1	1	1.1
D	1	1	2	1	2	1	1	1.3
E	2	2	1	1	1	2	1	1.4
F	1	2	2	1	2	2	2	1.7
G	2	2	2	1	2	2	2	1.9
H	2	2	3	1	2	2	2	2.0
I	4	2	1	2	3	2	3	2.4
J	4	2	3	3	3	2	2	2.7
K	2	4	4	4	4	4	4	3.7
L	1	5	5	3	4	5	5	4.0
M	5	5	4	4	4	4	4	4.3
N	5	5	5	5	5	4	4	4.7
School Two: Ranked 48th out of 49 that had at least 100 respondents (N=354 students)								
A	4	4	1	1	1	2	1	2.0
B	4	5	1	1	1	3	2	2.4
C	4	1	4	4	2	1	1	2.4
D	5	2	3	1	3	3	2	2.7
E	5	2	4	3	3	2	2	3.0
F	3	3	2	3	3	4	4	3.1
G	5	3	3	2	2	4	3	3.1
H	5	5	1	4	2	3	3	3.3
I	5	4	2	4	3	3	4	3.6
J	5	5	3	5	4	5	4	4.4
K	5	4	4	4	5	5	5	4.6
L	5	5	5	5	3	5	4	4.6

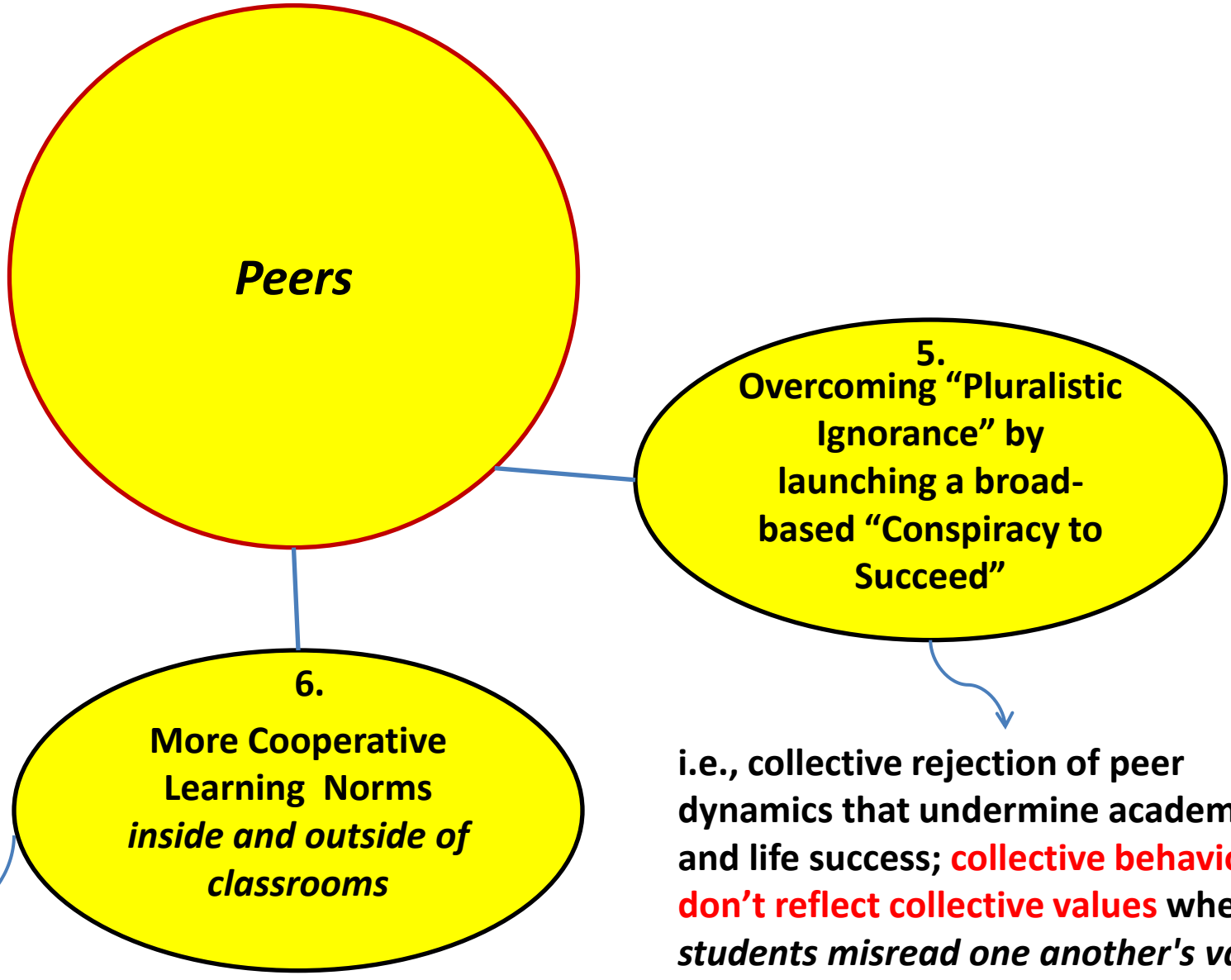
Numbers and colors indicate quintiles in the North Carolina secondary school distribution.

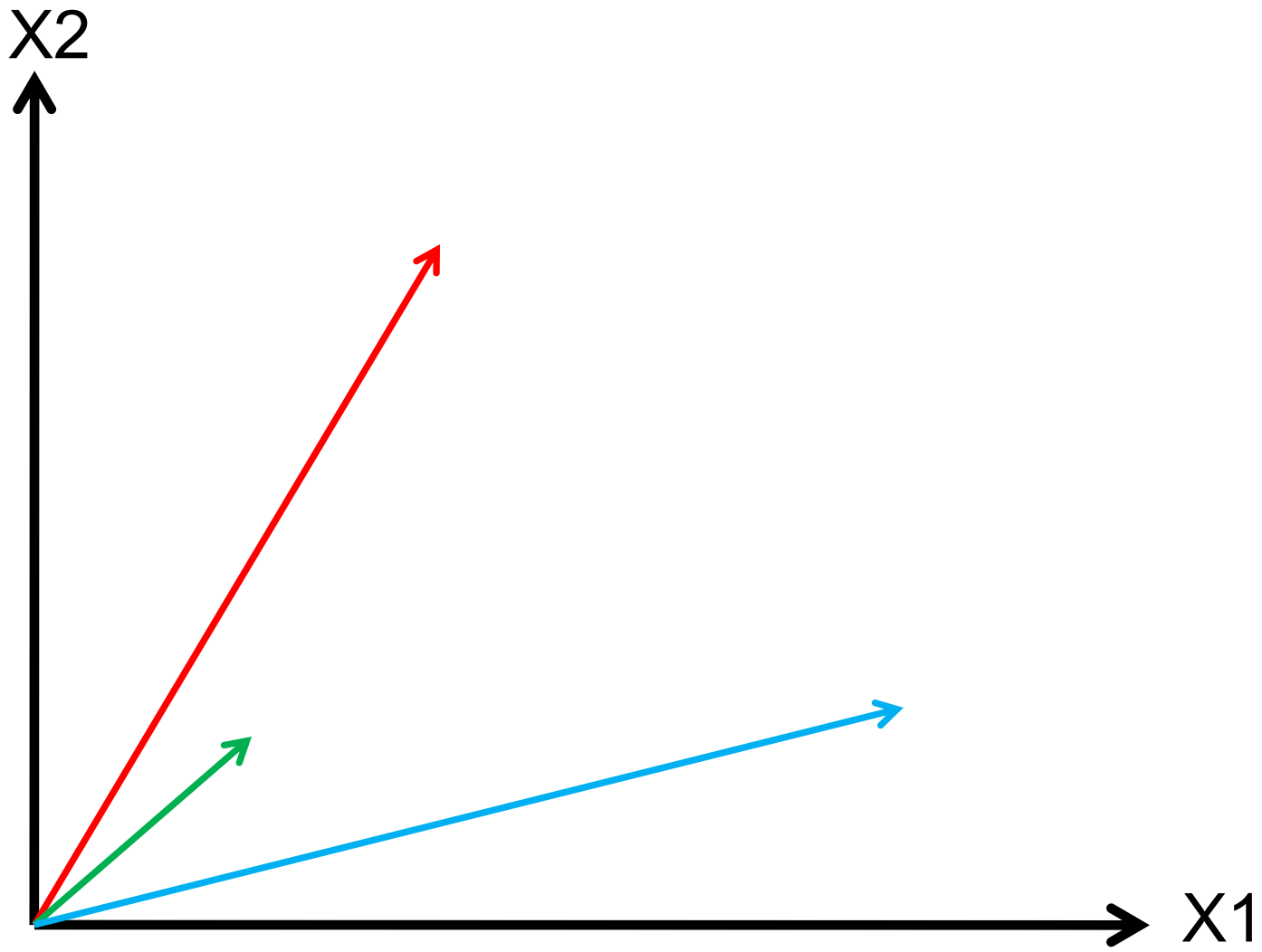
Some findings from the Gates Foundation **Measures of Effective Teaching** Project

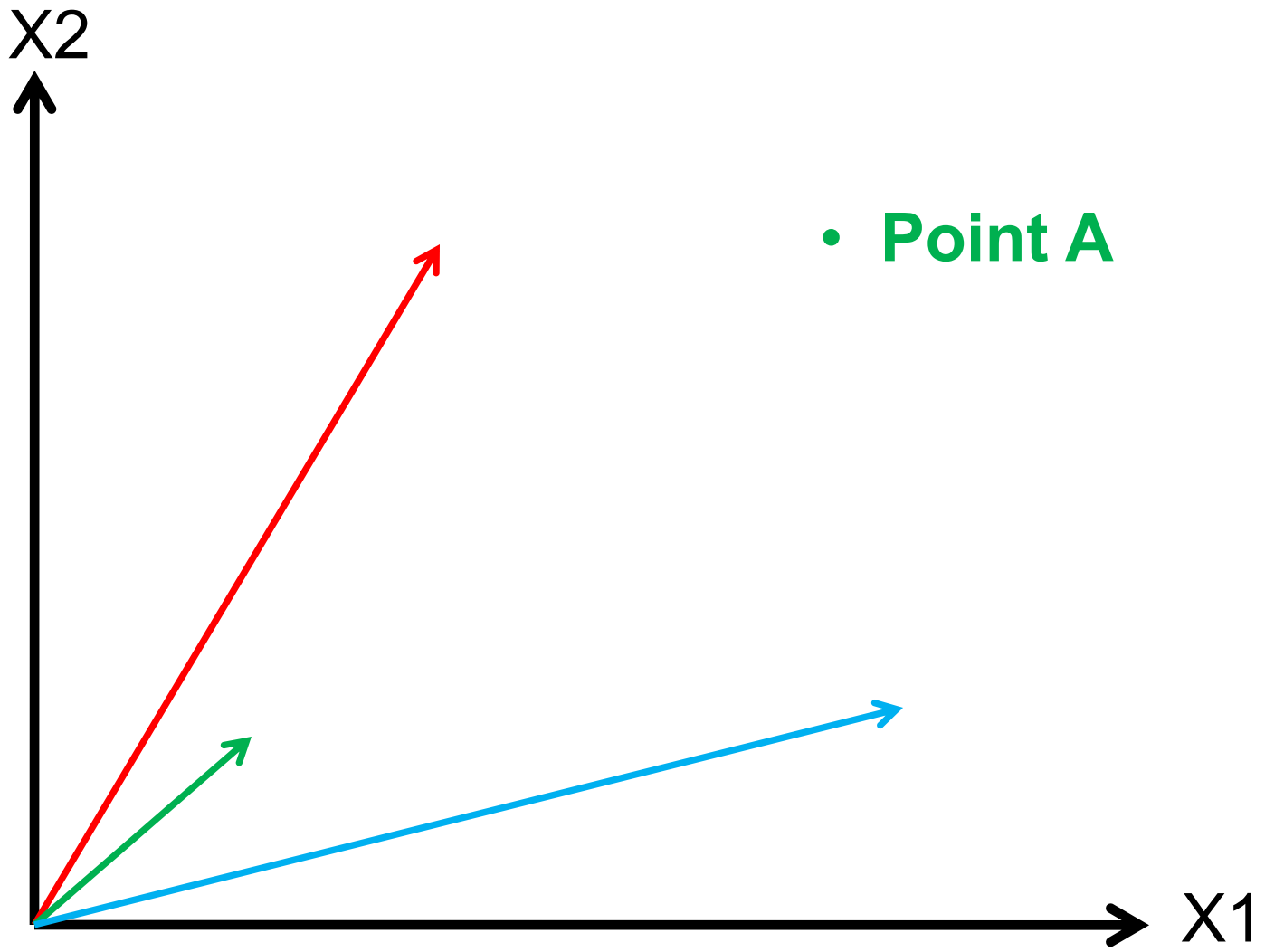
Predicted differences in months of learning for classrooms at the 25th versus the 75th percentile positions of the composite Seven C's distribution for the MET sample

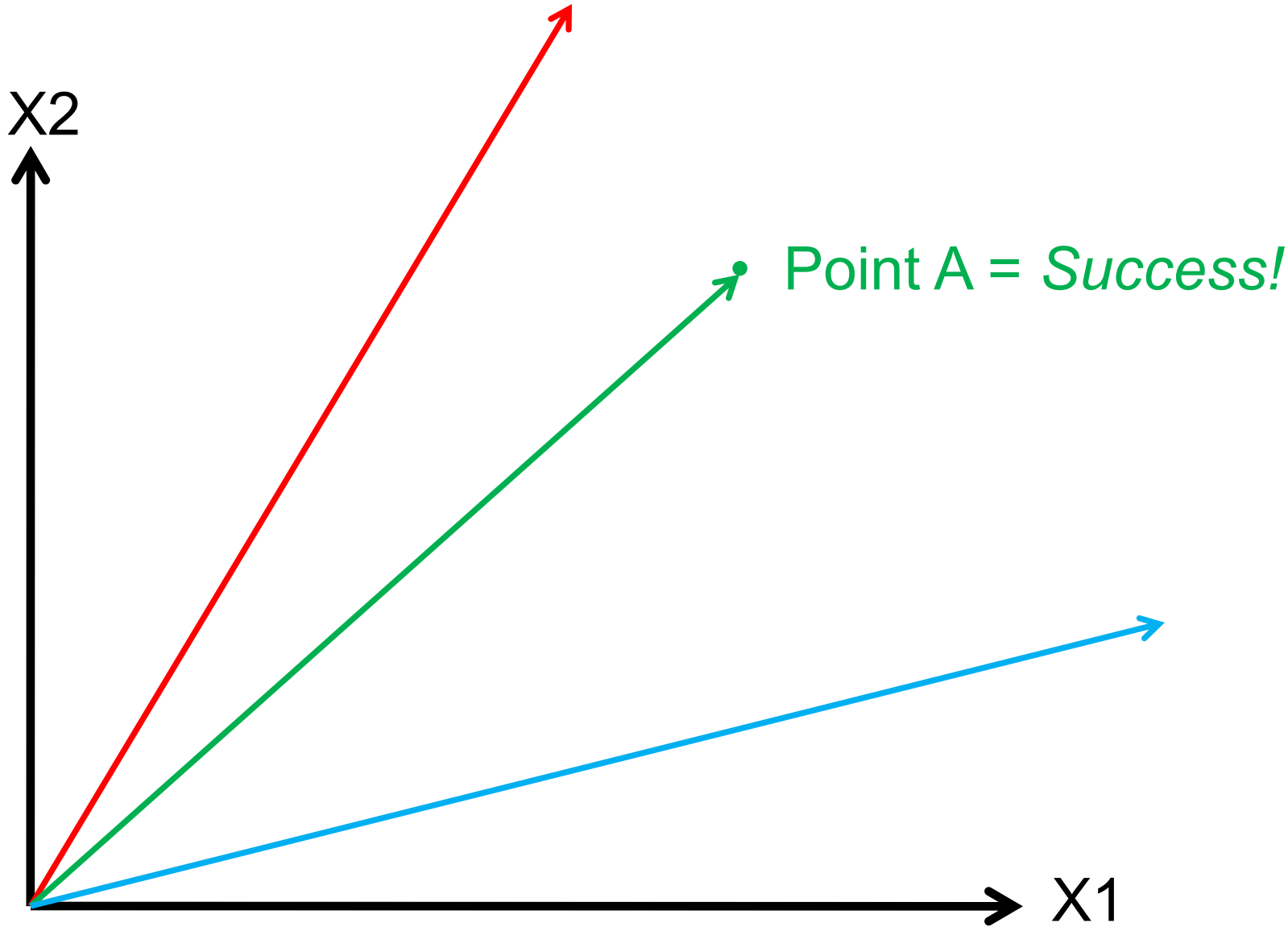
Using student survey responses in one section to predict learning gains in another.	Predicted difference per school year*
On state math tests	**4.8 months**
On the Balanced Assessment in Math	**3.7 months**
On state English Language Arts (ELA) tests	**2.3 months**
On the Stanford 9 Open Ended ELA	**2.9 months**

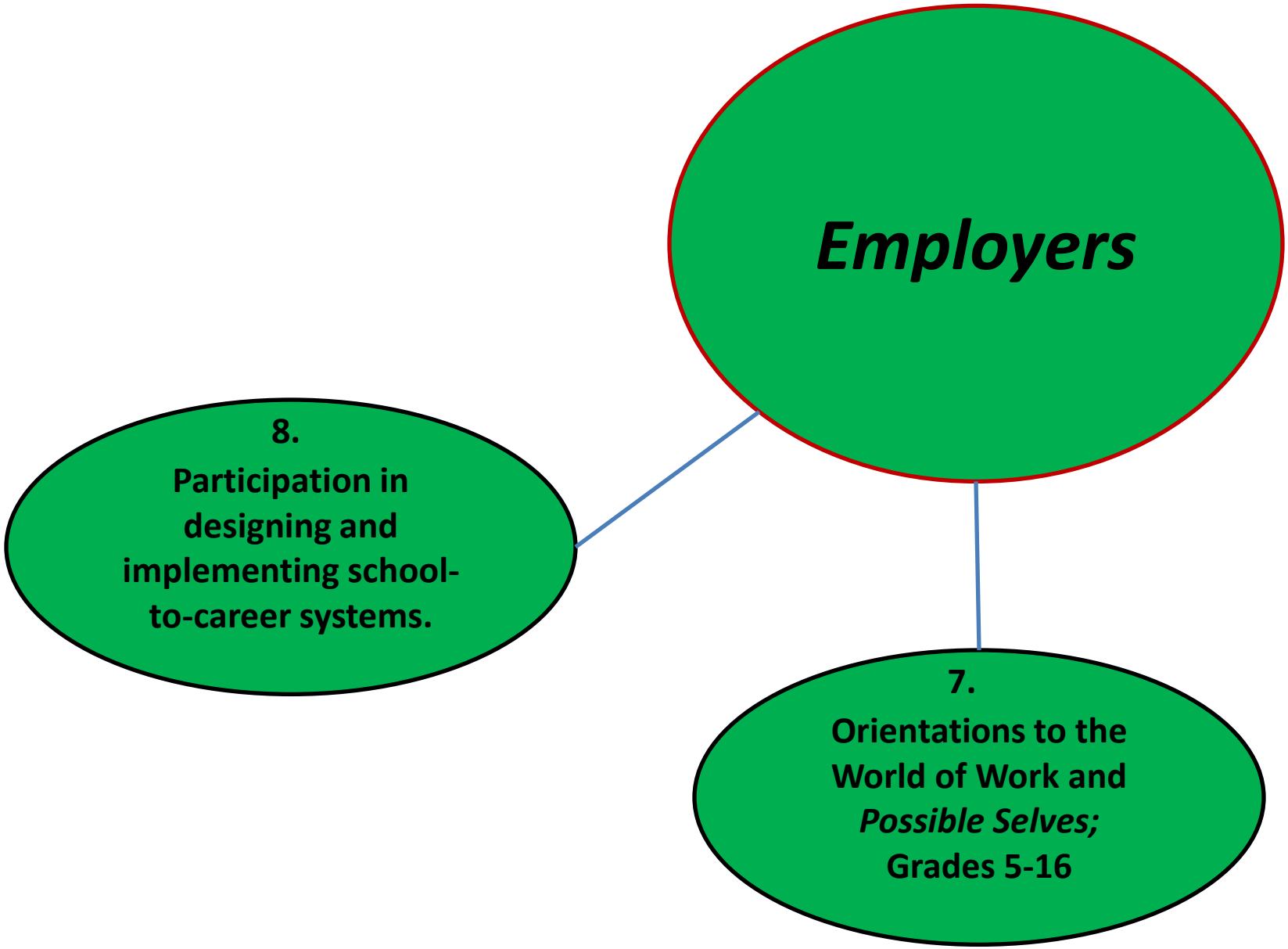
*Based on Table 9, p. 26: Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, "Learning about Teaching: Initial findings from the Measures of Effective Teaching Project." December 2010.

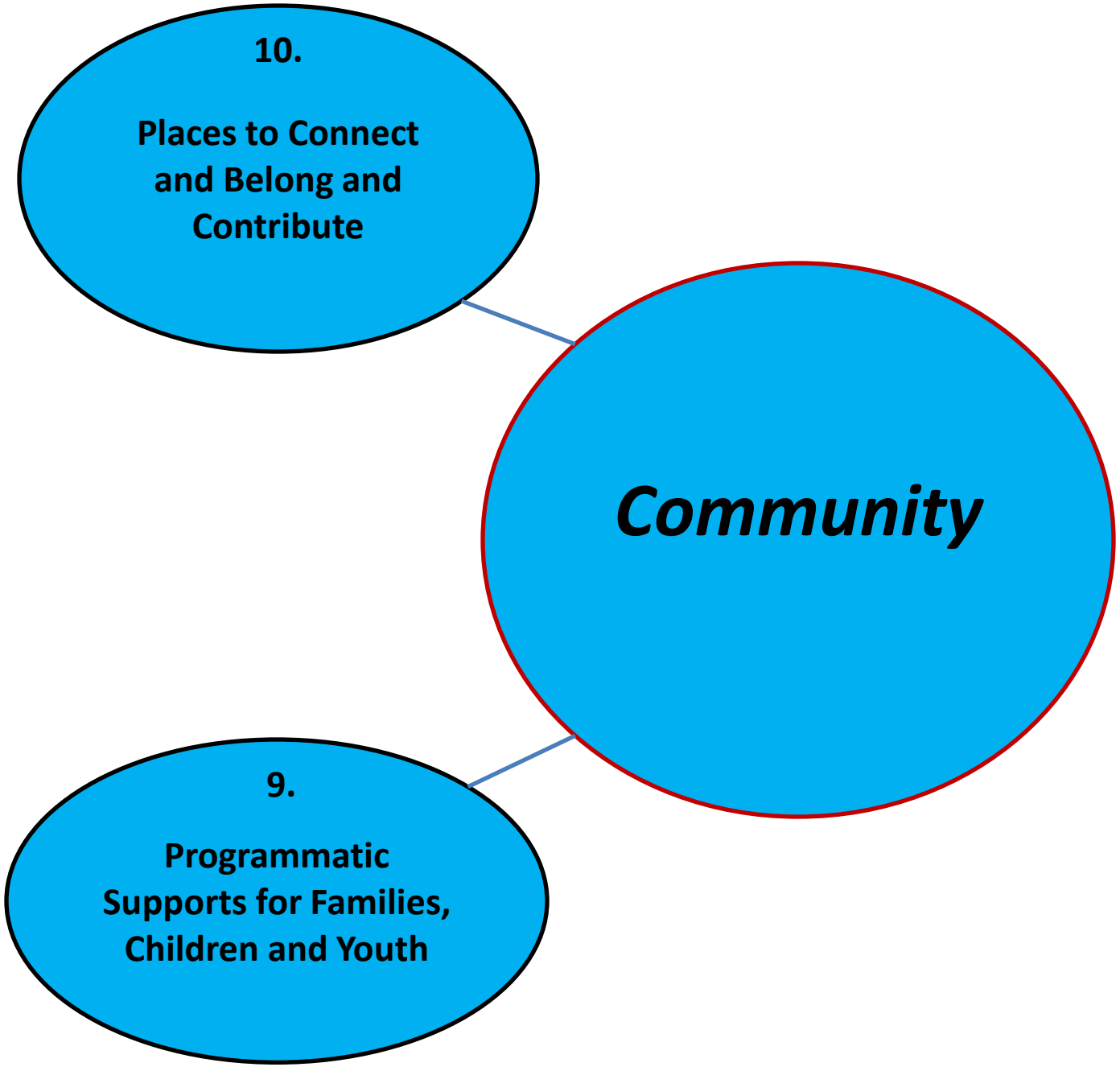

Peers
5.
Overcoming "Pluralistic Ignorance" by launching a broad-based "Conspiracy to Succeed"
6.
More Cooperative Learning Norms
inside and outside of classrooms
i.e., collective rejection of peer dynamics that undermine academic and life success; collective behaviors don't reflect collective values when students misread one another's values and hide their own in order to fit in.
Because high achievers are sometimes intellectual bullies.

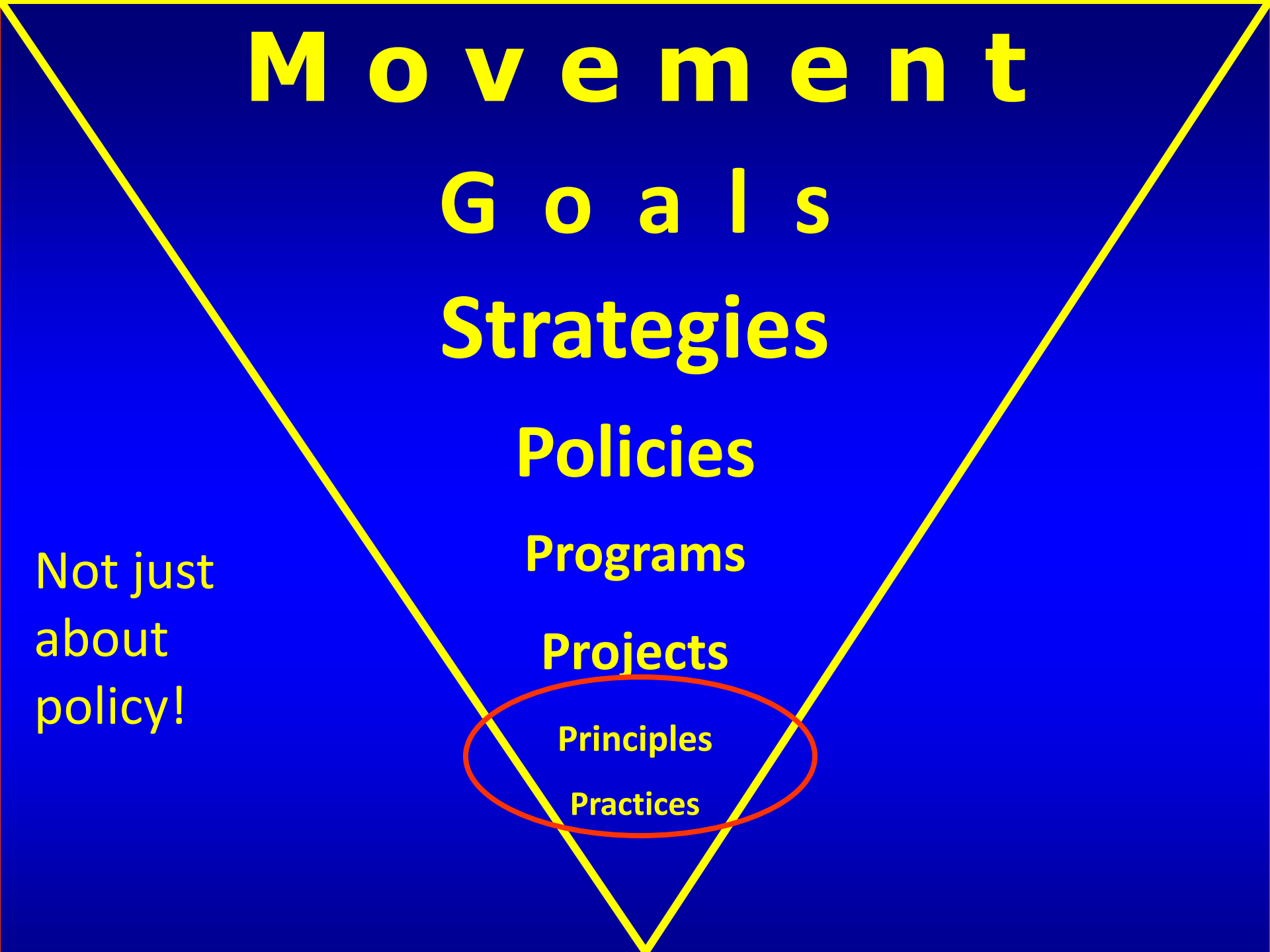

X2
X1

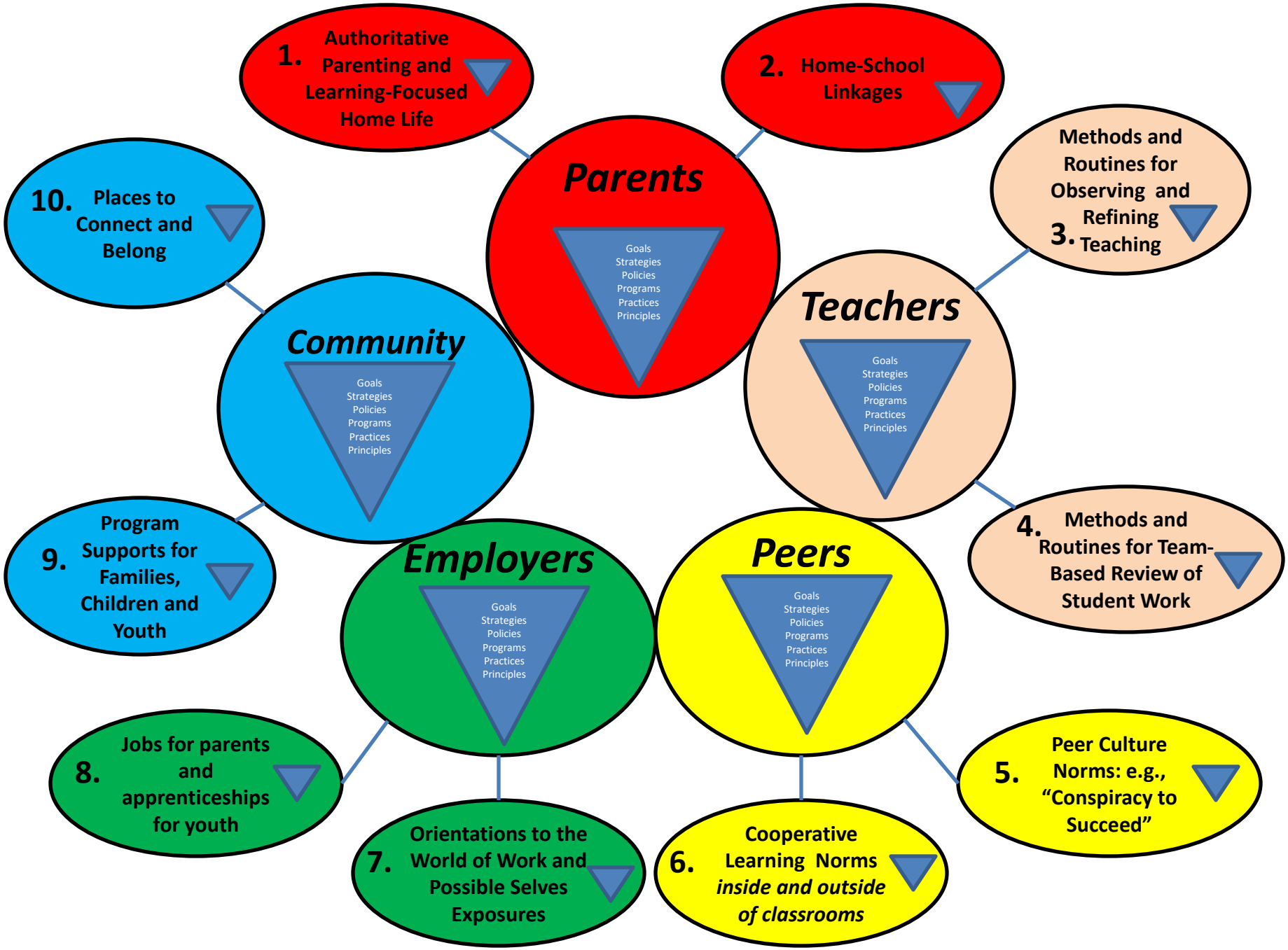

X2
Point A
X1


X2
Point A = *Success!*
X1


Employers
8.
Participation in designing and implementing school-to-career systems.
7.
Orientations to the World of Work and *Possible Selves;* Grades 5-16


10.
Places to Connect and Belong and Contribute
Community
9.
Programmatic Supports for Families, Children and Youth


Movement
Goals
Strategies
Policies
Programs
Projects
Principles
Practices
Not just about policy!


1. Authoritative Parenting and Learning-Focused Home Life
2. Home-School Linkages
Parents
Goals
Strategies
Policies
Programs
Practices
Principles
Methods and Routines for Observing and Refining 3. Teaching
Teachers
Goals
Strategies
Policies
Programs
Practices
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4. Methods and Routines for Team-Based Review of Student Work
10. Places to Connect and Belong
Community
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9. Program Supports for Families, Children and Youth
Employers
Goals
Strategies
Policies
Programs
Practices
Principles
Peers
Goals
Strategies
Policies
Programs
Practices
Principles
5. Peer Culture Norms: e.g., "Conspiracy to Succeed"
8. Jobs for parents and apprenticeships for youth
7. Orientations to the World of Work and Possible Selves Exposures
6. Cooperative Learning Norms inside and outside of classrooms

"Any fool can count the seeds in an apple, but only God can count the apples in a seed."

Rev. Dr. Robert Schuller

The bounty of the harvest depends upon the *effectiveness of cultivation,* and the effectiveness of cultivation depends, over time, on the *intensity of the search* for effective methods and the *dedication of effort* to help children reach their potential.